



A modern-day chip



Jack Kilby, the Father of the Integrated Circuit

thing electronic from wristwatches to space shuttles. At about the same time as Kilby, Robert Noyce of Fairchild Semiconductor independently invented another method of IC fabrication. These innovations have contributed to a market that is worth more than \$1 trillion today (Rs 41 lakh crore) and growing. Kilby received the 2000 Nobel Prize in Physics for his work.

Summer Of '58: LISP, the language of AI

LISP was invented by John McCarthy, the father of AI, and implemented on an IBM 704 computer. It is, after FORTRAN, the second-oldest high level language in use. It found use in AI research and pioneered many new concepts like tree data structures, object oriented programming, and dynamic typing. Linked lists were a major innovation; in fact, “LISP” comes from “List Processor.” LISP has seen many ups and downs, though there has been a flurry of activity in recent years related to open source implementation of portable libraries and applications. The first LISP compiler was completed in 1962; it was written in LISP.

October: NASA gets off the ground...

NASA (National Aeronautics and Space Administration) began operations; it was at the forefront of developing technologies in every sphere related to the US space programme. In the early days,